

# Donation Campaigns

User Manual — configuring and using the extension

Version 1.0.0-beta3

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## 1. What it does

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Donation Campaigns attaches a **fundraising campaign to a topic** and shows a box above that topic's first post with the target amount, the amount collected, a progress bar and — optionally — the number of donations and the donors' names.

Two things are important before you start:

- **It records confirmed donations only.** A donation is money that has *already arrived* and that you enter by hand. The extension **does not process payments** and never talks to PayPal, a bank or any provider.
- **The "donate" button is just a link.** Each campaign points it at a web address you choose (a PayPal link, a bank-details page, another topic...). Whoever clicks it leaves the board; you confirm the money yourself afterwards.

## 2. Install and enable

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1. Copy the extension to `ext/uflagmeyer/donationcampaigns/` on your board.
2. Go to **ACP** → **Customise** → **Extensions** → **Donation Campaigns** → **Enable**.

Or from the command line:

```
php bin/phpbbcli.php extension:enable uflagmeyer/donationcampaigns
php bin/phpbbcli.php cache:purge
```

Enabling creates the database tables, the settings, the permissions and the ACP menu. **Disabling** later hides everything but keeps your data; **purging** (uninstalling) deletes all campaigns and donations permanently.

### Update from an earlier version

1. **Disable** the extension. Do *not* click **Delete data** — that removes every campaign and donation.
2. Upload the new files **over** the existing ones. Overwriting is safe; there is no need to delete the old folder first, and not deleting it means an interrupted upload leaves a working version behind.
3. **Check the upload is complete.** The extension folder must contain **twelve folders**: `acp`, `adm`, `config`, `controller`, `docs`, `event`, `exception`, `language`, `migrations`, `repository`, `service`, `styles`. FTP clients can skip folders without an obvious error.
4. **Enable** the extension again — this runs any new database migrations — and purge the cache.

⚠ **Updating from 1.0.0-beta1: re-assign the permissions.** beta1 used two *moderator* permissions. The update removes them together with their grants and replaces them with two

*forum* permissions, granted to nobody. Assign them again after updating (see §4). Existing campaigns and donations are not affected.

**Updating from 1.0.0-beta2:** nothing changes for your visitors. The new campaign list page stays off until you switch it on (§3, §8); the new tab in the posting form only does something when its checkbox is ticked (§5).

### 3. Configure the currency

Go to **ACP** → **Extensions** → **Donation campaigns** → **Settings**.

| Setting                         | Meaning                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Currency code                   | Three letters, e.g. EUR , USD , GBP                                                                                                               |
| Currency symbol                 | Shown next to every amount, e.g. €                                                                                                                |
| Symbol before the amount        | No (default) gives "10.00 €", Yes gives "€ 10.00". Applies to every amount shown — on the topic, the management pages, in the ACP and in the logs |
| Space between symbol and amount | Yes (default) keeps them apart, No gives e.g. "\$10.00". The space never wraps, so amount and symbol stay together                                |
| Decimal places                  | 2 for most currencies, 0 for yen, 3 for dinar                                                                                                     |
| Donors listed                   | How many donor names the public box shows before summarising the rest                                                                             |
| Show the campaign list page     | No (default). Yes adds a page listing all campaigns and a <b>Donation campaigns</b> entry in the quick links (see §8)                             |

⚠ **Set the decimal places before recording your first donation.** Amounts are stored as whole numbers of the smallest unit (250.00 € is stored as 25000 ). Changing this setting later **re-reads every stored amount** rather than converting it, so a figure can suddenly appear ten or a hundred times too big or small. The extension warns you and asks for confirmation if data already exists.

### 4. Decide who may manage campaigns

The extension has **three permissions**. Administrators already have full access after installation, so you only need this section to let **other people** help.

| Permission                        | Lets the holder...                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Manage donation campaigns</b>  | Create, edit, enable/disable and delete <i>empty</i> campaigns                                                                                                                |
| <b>Manage confirmed donations</b> | Add, edit and delete donations. ⚠ This exposes donor names, <b>private</b> donor identities and confirmed amounts — grant it only to people you trust with that personal data |
| (Administrator access)            | Everything above on every forum the administrator can read, plus the ACP oversight and maintenance pages. Granted to the Full and Standard Administrator roles automatically  |

The two management permissions are **forum permissions**: you grant them **per forum** to any user or group — moderators or not. They are **independent** — you can give someone one without the other. Nobody holds them after installation, and no default role contains them.

**Where to set them** (the two management permissions):

1. **ACP** → **Permissions** tab.
2. Under **Forum based permissions**, choose **Group forum permissions** (or *User forum permissions*).
3. Select the **group** (or user), then the **forum**.
4. Click **Advanced Permissions** and open the **Donation Campaigns** tab.
5. Set the permissions to **Yes** and click **Apply permissions**.

**Read access is required.** Whoever manages a campaign must also be able to read the forum (*Can read forum*). Without it, neither the menu entry nor the **Manage** button appears — for administrators too.

**Note:** the permissions grant nothing else: **no access to the Moderator Control Panel**, no other moderator ability, and the holder is **not listed as a moderator** of the forum.

**When trying it out:** test the permissions with an ordinary member account, not your own. Administrators and founders can do everything through administrator access and therefore always see every button — whether the forum permissions are set correctly only shows for an account without administrator rights.

## 5. Create a campaign

Campaigns are **created from the topic they belong to** — there is no topic number to type in.

1. Open the topic.
2. Click **Topic tools** (the wrench icon) → **Donation campaign**.
3. Fill in the form:

| Field                      | Notes                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Title</b>               | The heading of the public box                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Description</b>         | Optional. BBCode, smilies and links are allowed                                                                                                         |
| <b>Target amount</b>       | For example 250.00 or 250,00 . Must be above zero                                                                                                       |
| <b>Donation link</b>       | Optional. A full http:// or https:// address                                                                                                            |
| <b>Link text</b>           | The words on the button, e.g. <i>Donate via PayPal</i> . Required if a link is set                                                                      |
| <b>Show donor names</b>    | Whether the public box may list donor names                                                                                                             |
| <b>Show donation count</b> | Whether the box shows how many donations there are                                                                                                      |
| <b>Show donation date</b>  | Whether the donor list shows the date of each donation next to name and amount. Only has an effect when donor names are shown. Ticked for new campaigns |

4. Click **Submit**, then **Back to topic** — the box now appears above the first post.

One campaign per topic. The same **Donation campaign** menu entry later opens the **management page** for that campaign.

**Privacy and the donation date:** in a small community, date and amount together can make even an *anonymous* donation traceable to a person. Only switch the date on if that is acceptable for your campaign.

## Together with a new topic

When you start a **new topic** in a forum where you may manage campaigns, the posting form has a **Donation campaign** tab next to *Poll creation*. Tick **Attach a donation campaign to this topic** and fill in the same fields — leave the title empty to use the topic title. A wrong entry stops the post, like a wrong poll does, and keeps everything you typed. The campaign is created together with the topic; if the topic needs approval, the campaign waits with it. The tab does not appear when replying or editing, and **drafts do not keep the campaign fields**.

## 6. Manage an existing campaign

Click the **Manage** button in the campaign box — or open the topic → **Topic tools** → **Donation campaign**. The **Manage** button is shown only to people who hold either management permission on that forum (or administrators); visitors do not see it. A *disabled* campaign shows no box, so then the way in is through the topic tools.

The management page shows the campaign's status and its donations, with buttons for the actions you are allowed to perform:

- **Edit campaign** — change the title, target, link, etc.
- **Disable / Enable** — *Disable* hides the box from the topic but keeps every donation; *Enable* brings it back.
- **Delete** — only possible while the campaign has **no** donations. A campaign with donations must be disabled instead (an administrator can hard-delete it from the ACP if it really must go).

## 7. Record a donation

**Only after the money has actually arrived and you have checked it.**

1. Open the management page (**Manage** in the box, or **Topic tools** → **Donation campaign**).
2. Click **Add confirmed donation** (shown to holders of *Manage confirmed donations*).
3. Fill in the receipt:

| Field                      | Notes                                                                      |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Amount</b>              | The amount that actually arrived, <code>50.00</code> or <code>50,00</code> |
| <b>Received on</b>         | The date the <b>money arrived</b> , not today's date                       |
| <b>Donor</b>               | The name to show publicly. Leave empty to record it as <i>Anonymous</i>    |
| <b>Show donor publicly</b> | Untick to count the donation but hide the donor's name                     |

4. Click **Submit** — the campaign total is recalculated immediately.

The donation list on the management page also shows when each donation was **received**. Each donation in the list has **Edit** and **Delete** actions. A donation with its name hidden **still counts** towards the total and the donation count; only the name is withheld and shown as *Anonymous*.

**Ask a donor before publishing their name.** The extension cannot know whether you have their consent.

## 8. What your visitors see

On the topic, above the first post, the box shows the title, the optional description, a progress bar, the amount collected against the target, and — depending on the campaign's settings — the donation count, the list of donor names and the date of each donation. Every confirmed donation is included with its amount; a private donation appears as *Anonymous* with its amount, never hidden.

### Community Server Fund 2026

Help us cover this year's hosting and server costs so the forum stays fast, ad-free, and open to everyone. Every contribution counts — thank you for your support!

Collected: **200.00 €** — Target: **500.00 €** — 40%

6 donations

**Donors:**

- Laura Fischer — 20.00 €
- Anonymous — 30.00 €
- James Carter — 35.00 €
- Sarah Thompson — 40.00 €
- Anonymous — 25.00 €
- Michael Bennett — 50.00 €

[Donate Now](#)

With the donation date switched on, a donor-list entry reads like this: "Laura Fischer — 20.00 € (3 Oct 2026)".

## The campaign list

If the administrator has switched on **Show the campaign list page** (§3), the quick-links menu offers **Donation campaigns**. The page lists the campaigns, newest first, 25 per page: the campaign title (a link to its topic), the forum, the progress bar, collected against target with the percentage and — if the campaign shows it — the number of donations. **It never shows donor names**; those stay in the topic.

Each visitor sees only the campaigns whose box they could also see in the topic: enabled campaigns in forums they may read, on topics that are approved and not deleted, and not in a password-protected forum they have not entered yet. Guests therefore see the campaigns in forums guests may read. A campaign that has reached its target is listed like the others, with a full bar.

## 9. Administrator oversight

The ACP (**ACP** → **Extensions** → **Donation campaigns**) is for **oversight and maintenance**, not day-to-day entry:

- **Campaigns** — a read-only list of every campaign on the board. Its row links open the campaign on its topic.
- **Donations** — a read-only list of a campaign's donations, with a link to manage them on the topic.
- **Recalculate total** — rebuilds a campaign's stored total from its donations (safe to run any time; useful after a restored backup).
- **Delete** — an administrator may delete even a **non-empty** campaign here (this cascades its donations); the confirmation names the campaign and its donation count.

**Where actions are logged:** work done from a topic is recorded in the **moderator log**, scoped to the forum and topic — also when the person acting is not a moderator. Read it under **ACP** → **Maintenance** → **Moderator log** (moderators of that forum also find it in the MCP). Work done in the ACP is recorded in the **administrator log** (**ACP** → **Maintenance** → **Admin log**).

## 10. Troubleshooting

| Symptom                                                                        | Check                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The box does not appear on the topic                                           | Is the campaign <b>enabled</b> ? Purge the cache                                                                                                                                 |
| After an update the box and the menu entry are gone, but the ACP works         | The upload is incomplete: does the extension folder contain all <b>twelve folders</b> (see §2)? Upload the missing folders, disable and re-enable the extension, purge the cache |
| The total looks wrong                                                          | Use <b>Recalculate total</b> in the ACP                                                                                                                                          |
| Amounts are off by a factor of ten or a hundred                                | The <b>decimal places</b> setting was changed after data was recorded (see §3)                                                                                                   |
| A donor's name shows when it should not                                        | Check both switches: the campaign's <b>Show donor names and</b> that donation's <b>Show donor publicly</b>                                                                       |
| The <b>Donation campaign</b> menu entry or the <b>Manage</b> button is missing | The user has neither management permission on that forum, or cannot read the forum (see §4). After an update from beta1: re-assign the permissions (see §2)                      |
| The <b>Add confirmed donation</b> button is missing                            | The <i>Manage confirmed donations</i> permission is missing — it is independent of <i>Manage donation campaigns</i>                                                              |
| A test user sees everything without holding the permissions                    | Is the user an administrator or founder? Then administrator access applies (see §4)                                                                                              |
| The <b>Donation campaign</b> tab is missing in the posting form                | It only appears for a <b>new topic</b> in a forum where the user may manage campaigns (see §4) — never when replying or editing                                                  |

| Symptom                                              | Check                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The campaign fields were empty after loading a draft | Drafts keep only subject and message; fill the fields in again                                                       |
| The campaign list says the page could not be found   | <b>Show the campaign list page</b> is switched off (default, see §3).<br>After an update: purge the cache            |
| A campaign is missing from the campaign list         | Is it <b>enabled</b> ? May the visitor read the forum? Is the forum password-protected and not yet entered? (see §8) |

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More detail is in the full documentation shipped with the extension: `README.md`, `docs/ADMIN_GUIDE.md` and `docs/PRIVACY.md`.